

Xuanbin Yang

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Empirical Asset Pricing; Financial Machine Learning; Time-Series Analysis; Nonparametric Statistics.

EDUCATION

- NANKAI UNIVERSITY, SCHOOL OF FINANCE Sep 2022 – Expected Jun 2027
Ph.D. in Finance (Financial Econometrics)
Advisor: Prof. Tingting Cheng.
- MONASH UNIVERSITY, MONASH BUSINESS SCHOOL Mar 2026 – Mar 2027
Visiting Ph.D. in Econometrics, Department of Econometrics and Business Statistics
Advisor: Prof. Jiti Gao. Funded by the China Scholarship Council.
- SOUTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY OF FINANCE AND ECONOMICS, SCHOOL OF FINANCE Sep 2018 – Jun 2022
Bachelor's Degree in Finance, Finance and Artificial Intelligence Experimental Program
GPA: 3.9/4.0; top 3%; Outstanding Graduate.

RESEARCH PAPERS

Published and Forthcoming

- Economic Policy Uncertainty and Municipal Corporate Bond Credit Spreads: Evidence from China (*with Tingting Cheng, L. Qiu, W. Lv, and G. Yang*). *Finance Research Letters*, 69, 106170, 2024.

Revise and Resubmit

- Predicting the Predictable: Decomposing and Forecasting Stock Returns in a Data-Rich Environment (*with Tingting Cheng and Albert Bo Zhao*). Revise and resubmit at *Management Science*.
- Binary Response Forecasting under a Factor-Augmented Framework (*with Tingting Cheng, Jiachen Cong, and Fei Liu*). Revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Applied Econometrics*.
- Market Expectations in the Cross-Section of Leading Present Values (*with Mengmeng Guo and Qihua Xu*). Revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Financial Econometrics*.

Under Review

- Extracting Predictability: A Time-Varying Factor-Augmented Approach under Mixed Persistence (*with Tingting Cheng, Jiti Gao, and Yayi Yan*). Under review at the *Journal of Econometrics*.

Working Papers

- FISTRA: A Financial-Factor-Informed Set Transformer for Learning Tradable Factors from Stock Cross-Sections
- Factor-Augmented Bootstrap Tests of Return and Dividend-Growth Predictability
- Testing Smooth and Abrupt Structural Change in Factor-Augmented Regressions
- Time-Varying Scaled PCA: A Nonparametric Method for Adaptive Factor Screening

RESEARCH GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- China Scholarship Council Scholarship for Joint Ph.D. Training
Monash University, Australia
Recipient of a 12-month scholarship for visiting doctoral research in econometrics. Mar 2026 – Mar 2027
- National Natural Science Foundation of China General Program (No. 72173068)
Theory and Applications of Varying-Coefficient Factor-Augmented Models in the Big-Data Era
Project participant. Principal investigator: Prof. Tingting Cheng. Jan 2022 – Dec 2025

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

All presentations listed below were delivered orally.

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| Jun 2026 | CASE International Workshop on Machine Learning and Applications in Financial Econometrics
<i>Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, Chengdu, China</i> |
| Dec 2025 | 6th Workshop on Big Data Econometrics: Theory and Applications
<i>Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, Wuhan, China</i> |
| Oct 2025 | 22nd Chinese Finance Annual Meeting
<i>Nanjing University, Nanjing, China</i> |
| Jul 2025 | 2025 International Conference on Econometrics and Statistics (ICES 2025)
<i>Harbin Institute of Technology, Harbin, China. Best Student Oral Presentation Award.</i> |
| Dec 2024 | 40th Anniversary Conference and 2024 Annual Meeting of the National Association of Industrial Statistics Teaching and Research
<i>Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Shanghai, China</i> |
| Jul 2024 | International Workshop on Financial Econometrics: Applications and Practice
<i>Nankai University, Tianjin, China</i> |
| Jun 2024 | ICSA 2024 China Conference
<i>Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, Wuhan, China</i> |
| May 2024 | 10th Jingshi Scholars Forum and 5th Tsinghua-Peking-Renmin Graduate Forum in Economics and Management
<i>Renmin University of China, Beijing, China</i> |
| Dec 2023 | National Academic Forum for Ph.D. Students in Quantitative Economics
<i>Xiamen University, Xiamen, China</i> |

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Gongneng Scholarship, Nankai University (four times).
- Outstanding Graduate; Outstanding Student, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics.
- Innovation and Entrepreneurship Scholarship; Labor Literacy and Skills Scholarship; Social Work and Volunteer Service Scholarship, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics.
- Honorable Mention, COMAP Mathematical Contest in Modeling.
- Provincial Second Prize, China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling.
- Provincial First Prize, Sichuan Provincial College Student FinTech Modeling Competition.
- Provincial Third Prize, Chinese Mathematics Competitions.
- Sichuan Province A-Level Certificate for College Student Comprehensive Quality.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND SKILLS

*Referee service: **Econometric Reviews**; **Finance Research Letters**; **Economic Modelling**.*

Software: MATLAB; Python; R; Stata; $\text{\LaTeX}$.